

HRMS

UI/UX Product Standard

Domain Standard #04 · Modern Human Resource Management System

Design direction: Human-centered Enterprise SaaS · Calm · Inclusive · Intelligent · Self-service

Purpose: Establish a reusable UI/UX standard for employee lifecycle, workforce operations, attendance, leave, payroll, performance and HR administration.

Modernity rule: The HRMS should feel like a contemporary employee experience platform, not a legacy HR database.

1. HRMS Product Definition

An HRMS manages the employee lifecycle and workforce operations while serving two distinct audiences: employees seeking simple self-service and HR/administrators managing complex policies and organizational data.

Core UX objective: make employee actions effortless while giving HR teams precise operational control, visibility and governance.

Primary user groups

- **Employees:** attendance, leave, payslips, requests, profile and self-service.
- **Managers:** team attendance, approvals, performance and workforce visibility.
- **HR:** employee lifecycle, policies, records, payroll inputs and reporting.
- **Executives:** workforce health, headcount, costs and organizational trends.
- **Administrators:** roles, permissions, policies, integrations and configuration.

2. Modern HRMS Design Language

Style type: Human-centered Enterprise SaaS / Employee Experience Platform

- **Visual tone:** approachable, trustworthy, calm and professional.
- **Layout:** clean modular workspace with role-aware dashboards and contextual detail.
- **Density:** low-to-medium for employee self-service; medium-to-high for HR operations.
- **Surfaces:** lightweight cards, clear sections, subtle borders and restrained elevation.
- **Navigation:** simple role-aware navigation with a stronger information architecture for HR administrators.
- **Interaction:** quick actions, contextual approvals, inline updates, search and progressive disclosure.
- **Personalization:** employee dashboards should prioritize the tasks and information relevant to the individual.

3. Current HRMS UI Pattern Expectations

Use current SaaS patterns to reduce administrative friction while keeping sensitive workforce information understandable.

Pattern	HRMS expectation	Example
Role-aware home	Different users see different priorities.	Employee sees leave balance; manager sees pending approvals.
Self-service actions	Common tasks available without HR intervention.	Apply leave, download payslip, update profile.
Action center	Centralize pending tasks and approvals.	Leave, attendance correction and expense requests.
Employee profile	Create one contextual employee workspace.	Identity + employment + attendance + documents + activity.
Timeline	Show meaningful lifecycle events.	Joined → promoted → transferred → reviewed.
Calendar/workforce view	Visualize attendance, leave and schedules.	Team availability and leave calendar.
Smart search	Search employees, policies and records quickly.	Find employee or policy from one search.
Progressive disclosure	Keep sensitive/advanced information out of the default view.	Payroll details behind appropriate sections/permissions.

Pattern	HRMS expectation	Example
AI assistance	Support summaries, policy discovery and workflow assistance.	Ask a policy question and receive source-linked guidance.
Mobile-first actions	Optimize frequent employee tasks for mobile.	Check-in, leave request, payslip and approvals.

4. HRMS Information Architecture

- **Home:** personalized tasks, announcements, balances, alerts and quick actions.
- **People:** employee directory, profiles, organization and workforce structure.
- **Attendance:** attendance, shifts, schedules, corrections and workforce calendars.
- **Leave:** balances, policies, requests, approvals and holiday calendars.
- **Payroll:** payroll runs, earnings, deductions, payslips and statutory information.
- **Performance:** goals, reviews, feedback and development plans.
- **Recruitment:** requisitions, candidates, interviews and onboarding where included.
- **Reports & Analytics:** headcount, attendance, attrition, payroll and workforce reporting.
- **Administration:** policies, workflows, roles, permissions, organization and integrations.

5. HRMS Navigation Standard

Recommended model: Role-aware Home → Domain → Task → Record → Action.

- Keep employee navigation intentionally simple.
- Expose HR administrative complexity progressively.
- Provide global employee search for authorized users.
- Keep notifications, approvals, profile and help consistently accessible.
- Use contextual navigation between employee, attendance, leave, payroll and performance records.
- Preserve filters and view state for HR operational screens.

6. Design System Foundations

Foundation	HRMS standard
Grid	12-column desktop system; responsive employee experience.
Spacing	4px base; 8/12/16/24/32px primary rhythm.
Typography	Modern sans-serif with highly readable body text and clear hierarchy.
Radius	6–10px for controls/surfaces; restrained use of pills for status.
Color	Neutral foundation + brand accent + semantic status colors.
Density	Comfortable default; compact density for HR expert workflows where useful.
Motion	Subtle transitions for requests, approvals, panels and status updates.
Accessibility	WCAG 2.2 AA target; sensitive information must remain readable and navigable.

7. Employee Home Experience

The employee home should behave like a personal work assistant: concise, actionable and relevant.

- Show today's attendance or work status where relevant.
- Surface leave balance and quick leave request.
- Show upcoming holidays, shifts, meetings or required actions.
- Provide payslip/documents access without deep navigation.
- Show pending requests and approval outcomes.
- Use announcements sparingly and prioritize relevant information.
- Allow quick access to profile, support and policy information.

8. Employee Profile Standard

- **Header:** name, photo/avatar, employee ID, role and department.
- **Employment:** joining date, manager, location, employment status and organization.
- **Personal:** authorized personal details with privacy-aware presentation.
- **Work:** attendance, leave, goals and performance sections based on permissions.
- **Documents:** controlled access to contracts, certificates and HR documents.
- **Activity:** relevant requests and lifecycle events.
- Sensitive information should be permission-aware and never unnecessarily exposed.

9. Attendance & Workforce UX

- Use a clear daily/weekly status view rather than an opaque raw log.
- Make check-in/check-out actions highly visible when applicable.
- Show schedule, actual attendance and exceptions distinctly.
- Use calendar views for shifts, holidays and team availability.
- Make corrections easy to request while preserving audit history.
- Highlight exceptions such as missing check-ins or unusual attendance patterns without using punitive visual language.

10. Leave Management UX

- Show available balance before request submission.
- Use a simple request flow with date selection, leave type, duration and reason where required.
- Preview the impact on balance before submission.
- Show approval state clearly: Draft, Pending, Approved, Rejected or Cancelled.
- Provide managers with team calendar context before approving.
- Use clear policy guidance next to decisions rather than forcing users to search separately.

11. Payroll UX Standard

- Prioritize clarity and trust over visual decoration.
- Separate earnings, deductions, taxes and net pay clearly.
- Show pay period and effective date prominently.
- Provide transparent breakdowns for calculated amounts.
- Keep sensitive payroll data permission-controlled.
- Use downloadable payslip/document actions with clear status.
- Use confirmation and audit patterns for payroll-impacting administrative changes.

12. HR Approval Center

Approvals should be treated as an action workspace, not merely a notification list.

- Group requests by type and urgency.
- Show employee context, request details and relevant policy before decision.
- Make Approve, Reject and Request Changes semantically distinct.
- Require reasons when business policy demands them.
- Support bulk approval only for low-risk homogeneous requests.
- Show decision history and timestamps.

13. Performance & Goals UX

- Use goal cards or progress views to make objectives understandable.
- Separate employee self-reflection from manager evaluation.
- Use timelines for review cycles and feedback.
- Show progress trends without implying false precision.
- Support comments and structured feedback in context.
- Make review status and next step obvious.

14. AI & Intelligent HR Standard

HR AI requires especially strong transparency, privacy and human oversight.

- Use AI for policy search, document summarization, HR query assistance and administrative drafting where appropriate.
- Clearly identify generated content.
- Do not make consequential employment decisions solely from opaque AI outputs.
- Provide source/context for policy answers.
- Allow HR professionals to verify and override recommendations.
- Keep sensitive employee information governed by explicit permissions and data policies.

15. Example — Leave Request Flow

- **Start:** employee selects Leave from quick actions.

- **Context:** show balance, upcoming holidays and existing leave.
- **Request:** select type, dates, duration and optional reason.
- **Preview:** show balance after request and approval route.
- **Submit:** clear confirmation and pending status.
- **Manager:** approval center shows request + team calendar + policy context.
- **Completion:** employee receives decision and updated balance.

16. Example — Employee Onboarding

- Use a progress-based onboarding workspace.
- Show tasks grouped by employee, HR and manager ownership.
- Track document completion, profile setup, policy acknowledgement and required training.
- Provide clear completion percentage only when it reflects real required work.
- Use reminders and exception states without overwhelming the employee.
- Finish with a clear transition from onboarding to normal employee home.

17. Accessibility & Inclusive UX

- Target WCAG 2.2 AA for core workflows.
- Use accessible labels and keyboard navigation.
- Never rely on color alone for attendance, approval or payroll states.
- Provide accessible calendar controls.
- Maintain readable typography and sufficient contrast.
- Respect reduced motion and zoom.
- Use inclusive, neutral language in HR workflows.

18. Responsive & Mobile Strategy

- **Desktop:** HR administration, payroll, workforce analytics and complex configuration.
- **Tablet:** manager approvals, workforce views and employee self-service.
- **Mobile:** attendance, leave, approvals, notifications, payslips and profile actions.
- Use bottom sheets, focused forms and card-based records where appropriate on mobile.
- Do not compress complex HR tables into unreadable layouts.

19. HRMS UX Quality Gates

Gate	Validation question
Employee simplicity	Can an employee complete common tasks without HR assistance?
Administrative control	Can HR manage complex policies without excessive navigation?
Privacy	Is sensitive employee information exposed only where authorized?
Trust	Are payroll, attendance and approval states understandable?

Gate	Validation question
Workflow clarity	Is ownership and next action obvious?
Accessibility	Can all core tasks be completed with accessible interaction?
Scalability	Does the system work for growing organizations and complex structures?
Modernity	Does the interface feel current without sacrificing enterprise clarity?

20. Design-Glanza Product Builder Rules

- Generate role-specific experiences for employee, manager, HR and administrator personas.
- Treat Employee, Attendance, Leave, Payroll, Performance and Approval as reusable domain objects.
- Generate all relevant states: draft, pending, approved, rejected, cancelled, completed, restricted and error.
- Use modern SaaS patterns such as action centers, self-service dashboards, contextual drawers, progressive disclosure and smart search.
- Use AI only with explicit transparency, privacy and human-review patterns.
- Generate responsive employee workflows as first-class experiences rather than desktop shrink-downs.
- Audit every generated HRMS for privacy, accessibility, permission accuracy and workflow clarity.

21. HRMS Standard Summary

Style: Human-centered Enterprise SaaS / Employee Experience Platform

UX model: Discover → Understand → Act → Approve → Track → Complete

Visual priority: task clarity → employee context → status → action → feedback

Modern patterns: role-aware home, action center, self-service, smart search, contextual panels, calendars and responsible AI assistance

Non-negotiables: privacy, accessibility, trust, permission accuracy, simplicity and scalability.

Domain Standard #04 for the Design-Glanza domain library. Domain-specific regulations, organization policies and research may extend this baseline; deviations should be intentional and documented.